# JAMES CHANG

*Senior Product Manager · AI-Assisted Builder · Los Angeles, CA*

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## ABOUT

I'm an AI-native Senior PM and operator. I design, prototype, and ship full-stack products end-to-end using Claude Code, Cursor, and Gemini — architecting systems, writing tests, deploying to production. AI didn't replace the PM skillset; it gave me a way to go from insight to working software without waiting for a sprint. Today I'm running Aleph Co. as founder and shipping seven other live products in parallel.

Before founding Aleph, I was Senior PM at Gannett/LocaliQ, where I owned Scheduling from concept to shipped product inside a media company and picked up SEO and GenAI ownership along the way. The operator problems I know best aren't confined to one market — they're how I pick what to build next.

Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US — at YETI, at Cheng Loong in Shanghai, at AT&T Wireless — gave me the domain knowledge that makes Aleph a domain-expert play, not a random SaaS bet. It's the “why I knew the gap was real,” not the headline.

MBA from USC Marshall (2012), CSPO, and a lifetime food blog at The Thirsty Pig. Based in Los Angeles.

## EXPERIENCE

***Sep 2025 — Present***
**Aleph Co.**
*Founder & Operator · Los Angeles, CA*

- Founded and operate Aleph, a B2B SaaS compliance platform for US importers covering FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, and multi-state PFAS regulations.
- Ship seven additional products in parallel under Aleph Co. — see Projects.

***Mar 2022 — Oct 2024***
**LocaliQ / USA Today Network**
*Senior Product Manager · Woodland Hills, CA*

- Owned Scheduling end-to-end — strategy, roadmap, discovery, launch — leading a cross-functional pod of engineering, design, QA, and Customer Success.
- 4,900 free + 400 paid accounts in year one against an internal plan projecting meaningfully smaller numbers. 8,000+ booked appointments in the first six months via Google Calendar, Outlook, and SMS integrations.
- Expanded scope to LocaliQ's SEO offering and its GenAI/Jasper tooling; defined the KPI and instrumentation layer fed to Sales and CS dashboards across the revenue org.

***Dec 2019 — Jun 2020***
**Sunrise Integration**
*Product / Project Manager · Los Angeles, CA*

- Owned WarehouseConnector.com product and integration delivery for OMS/ERP/CRM/WMS workflows used by logistics operators.
- Led Magento → Shopify platform migrations and NetSuite ERP modernization initiatives.

***Jun 2019 — Nov 2019***
**Movley (now Ops Ninja)**
*Product / Operations Manager · Remote*

- Delivered operational dashboards for manufacturing inspections and overseas fulfillment workflows.
- Built and managed distributed operations teams (China, Philippines) supporting U.S. manufacturing customers.

***Apr 2018 — Dec 2018***
**MEDL Mobile**
*Product / Project Manager · Irvine, CA*

- Led requirements, QA, and App Store submissions for mobile apps across consumer and emerging-tech engagements.
- Coordinated cross-functional delivery for multiple shipped applications under tight timelines with external stakeholders.

*2000 — 2017*
**Earlier · supply chain**
*YETI · AT&T · Cheng Loong (Shanghai) · Cobalt Skys · Spray Tech · Breeze (Taipei)*

- Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US — global packaging, telecom, paper, and consumer goods.
- Operator domain knowledge that made Aleph Co. a domain-expert play. In 2026, this is the why-not-someone-else moat — not the headline.

## EDUCATION

**USC Marshall School of Business**
*Master of Business Administration (MBA), 2012. Class President.*

### Certifications

- Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance · 2019
- Product Management Certificate, Product School · 2018
- Data-Driven Product Management, LinkedIn Learning · 2024
- Product Management: Building a Product Roadmap, LinkedIn Learning · 2024
- Technology for Product Managers, LinkedIn Learning · 2024
- Toggl Hire Product Development · 2024
- Appcues Basics · 2023
- Jasper Certified · 2023
- HubSpot Inbound Certification · 2019
- Google Analytics for Beginners · 2018

## SKILLS

**Product:** 0→1 development, roadmapping, discovery & user research, A/B testing, GenAI integration, native-mobile PM

**Tools:** Jira, Linear, Productboard, Figma, Notion, Confluence, Slack, Mixpanel, PostHog, Sentry, Google Analytics 4, Appcues, Stripe, Shopify, GitHub, Postman

**AI-Assisted Engineering:** Claude Code, Cursor, Gemini, ChatGPT Codex, VS Code, Xcode, Replit, MCP · TypeScript, Python, Next.js, React Native/Expo, Astro, Tailwind, FastAPI, Express, Prisma, Drizzle, Socket.IO

**Infrastructure:** Vercel, Railway, Render, Supabase, Neon, TinaCMS, BullMQ/Redis, Playwright, Tesseract.js OCR

**Domains:** B2B SaaS, regulatory compliance, fantasy sports, food & dining, global supply chain & sourcing

**Languages:** English (native), Mandarin (verbal fluency), Taiwanese (verbal fluency)

## PROJECTS

*8 products live · all AI-assisted · all shipped by one operator*

### Aleph Co.

Product compliance for US importers — FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, multi-state PFAS — one platform.

### The Fantastic Leagues

Fantasy baseball with league-context AI. 26 feature modules, 730 tests, 8 AI features (Gemini + Claude), live auction WebSockets.

### The Judge Tool

Digital KCBS BBQ competition judging. Real-time tabulation, audit trails, 16,424 LOC + 113 tests shipped in 20 days.

### Bahtzang Trader

AI trading-decision experiment using Claude Sonnet. Paper-trading sandbox — not a live trading service.

### TableDrop

Modular restaurant operating system — started as a reservation marketplace for Taipei, expanding into POS integration and supply chain. Next.js + Stripe + Playwright.

### KTV Singer

YouTube-powered karaoke system. Phone & Apple TV pairing, synced lyrics, shared queue. Expo + SwiftUI + Express + Socket.IO + Supabase.

### Tastemakers

iOS restaurant-review app. 1,000+ downloads in 3 months with no paid acquisition. Laravel 8 + PostgreSQL + Redis + Firebase push.

### The Thirsty Pig

Food and travel blog since 2007. 2026 rebuild: 923 posts recovered from the Wayback Machine, 1,649 Instagram posts archived, 2,900+ pages.

## MEMBERSHIPS & LEADERSHIP

**Chinese American Museum** *Board Member*
*Feb 2026 – Present · Los Angeles, CA*
Serving on the board of the Chinese American Museum in downtown Los Angeles, the first museum in the United States dedicated to the history and ongoing story of Chinese Americans.

**Kansas City Barbeque Society** *Certified BBQ Judge (CBJ) · Lifetime Member*
*2022 – Present*
KCBS-certified Barbeque Judge since 2022. Lifetime member; judged at 12+ sanctioned competitions. The domain knowledge behind building The Judge Tool.